

How to play Science Around the Board

Student Guide · last updated October 2026

Science Around the Board is a board game for reviewing your course. Teams roll dice, answer your instructor's questions to buy tiles, charge each other rent and capture corner exams. Every answer is followed by an explanation, so a wrong answer is a chance to learn, not a failure. It takes about five minutes to learn the rules.

The game runs in your web browser and you don't need an account. You can read this guide online or print it as a PDF.

Before you start

You need:

- **A computer** (a laptop, a desktop or a tablet held sideways; a phone screen is too small) with an up-to-date browser such as Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari. Your instructor will tell you how many teams share each computer. A computer can host 1 to 4 teams.
- **Your instructor's questions.** This is either a **game link** or a **question file** (`.tsv` , or a protected `.lock` file).
- **The class password**, but only if your file is a `.lock` file.
- **Any image files** your instructor gave you. They are optional.

Getting started

1. **Open the game.** Click your instructor's game link and the questions load by themselves. Without a link, go to <https://hghezzi.github.io/Science-Around-the-Board/>, find **Use your instructor's questions**, click **Upload** and choose the file.
 - If the file is protected, a box asks for the **Class password**. Type it, then click **Unlock**. Passwords are case-sensitive.
 - If your instructor gave you images, click **Optional: upload images** and select all the image files at once (Ctrl+A on Windows, ⌘A on a Mac).
2. **Check that it loaded.** The page shows *Loaded ... questions*. Click **Continue to game setup** →.

3. Set up the game:

1. **How many teams?** Choose *Solo* or *2, 3 or 4 teams* sharing this computer.
2. **Session length.** Pick the time your instructor asks for, or *No timer*.
3. **Choose a topic.** Click the topic, pick the module your instructor named under **Select module**, then click **Confirm selection**.

4. Click **Start game** →.

5. **Pre-game survey.** Each team answers in turn, and the screen shows whose turn it is (for example *Red Team · player 1 of 2*):

- rate your confidence on each slider (0 to 10), then click **Continue to Questions**;
- answer the 10 questions, then click **Next Player**. The last team clicks **Start Game**.

Answer honestly, without help from the other teams. The survey is your starting point, not a test, and the team with the best score goes first.

How to win

The game ends in one of two ways:

1. **Last team standing:** every other team has been eliminated by bankruptcy.
2. **Highest net worth:** when the timer runs out, or when your instructor asks you to click **End game**, the team with the highest net worth wins. Net worth is your cash plus the value of your tiles and upgrades.

Each team starts with **\$2,500**. Teams take turns, and the team panel on the right shows each team's cash and net worth.

Your turn

Click **Roll** (it shows your team's name). Your token moves around the board, and every time it passes **START** your team collects a **\$200 lap bonus**. Then the tile you land on decides what happens:

You land on...	What happens
An unowned tile	Answer a question. If you're right, you may Buy the tile for its price or Skip . If you're wrong, you pay \$20.
A rival's tile	You owe the owner rent, but you answer a question first. If you're right, you pay only half the rent. If you're wrong, you pay all of it.
Your own tile	Nothing happens.
An unowned corner (milestone)	You can take a 6-question exam on that side's theme. Start exam to try (you need \$500), or Decline . If you get 5 of 6 right, you pay \$500, own the corner and earn a $\propto$ Chaos Token. A second wrong answer ends the exam, and you pay nothing.
A rival's corner	The fee is \$250. Click Accept challenge to take the 6-question exam (if you get 5 of 6 right, you pay only half), or click Pay full .
A Wildcard	You draw a random event that pays or costs the amount shown, with a fun fact.

The core tiles (the ones in the middle of each side) work like other tiles: you buy them for \$200, and their rent is \$120.

Answering questions

Talk it over with your team before you answer. Clicking a multiple-choice option submits it straight away. The order of the options changes every time a question appears. Your instructor may also use these formats:

- **Select all that apply:** tick every correct option, then click **Submit answer**. You need exactly the right set.
- **Number:** type a number, then click **Submit answer**. For estimates, an answer close enough counts.
- **Put in order:** use the $\uparrow$ and $\downarrow$ buttons to arrange the steps, then click **Submit answer**.
- **Short answer:** type a word or short phrase. Capital letters, punctuation and one small typo in longer words don't matter.

After every answer you see the correct answer and an explanation, so read it before you click **Continue**. The same ideas come back later in the game.

Upgrades and Chaos Tokens

You can use these buttons during your turn, before you roll.

Upgrades

Each side of the board has two **colour groups** of three tiles. When your team owns all three tiles of a colour, click **Upgrades** to add a star (★) to the whole group, up to four stars. Rent rises steeply with each star:

Stars	none, group incomplete	none, full group	★	★★	★★★	★★★★
Rent on a \$100 tile	\$10	\$20	\$60	\$120	\$200	\$400
Rent on a \$160 tile	\$16	\$32	\$96	\$192	\$320	\$640

Each of the first three stars costs one tile's price (\$100 or \$160) for the whole group, and the fourth star costs twice that.

Chaos Tokens

You earn a ⚡ Chaos Token by capturing a corner milestone. Once all four corners are owned, you can also buy tokens for \$500. To use one, click **Use chaos**, then **Challenge** a rival's tile:

- **Right answer:** you take the tile for half its price, which goes to its owner. Any star on that tile is lost.
- **Wrong answer:** you pay a small fine to the bank.

The question comes from the tile's own topic, and you spend the token either way.

Running out of money

If your cash drops below \$0, the game helps you recover:

1. **Sell or downgrade.** You sell tiles or remove stars, at half their value, until you're back above \$0.
2. **Rescue Quiz (once per game).** If selling everything still wouldn't cover the debt, you get a 3-question **Rescue Quiz**. If you get 2 or more right, your debt is cleared and you receive \$500.
3. **Eliminated.** If you fail the Rescue Quiz, or go bankrupt a second time, your team is out of the game, and its tiles return to the bank. Stay at the computer: you still take the post-game survey.

Ending the game and handing in your results

This part counts: your instructor needs your results file.

1. When the timer ends, or when your instructor says so, click **End game** (top right). The **Final Standings** show the winner. Then click **Continue to post-survey**.
 - Don't click **Exit session** unless you really want to quit, because it throws away this game and its results.
2. **Post-game survey:** each team answers the same sliders and questions as before. The last team clicks **Finish Surveys**.
3. On the **Session complete** screen, type the **names or student IDs** of everyone on your team.
4. Hand in your results the way your instructor asked:
 - **Send results to instructor:** sends them straight to your instructor. Wait until the button shows **Sent** ✓.
 - **Email results to instructor:** downloads the results file and opens your email app. **Attach the downloaded file** before you send the email.
 - **Download results (CSV):** saves the file (named `sab_results_....csv`) so you can upload it where your instructor asked, for example on your course page.

The buttons you see depend on how your instructor set up the game. If **Send** fails, use **Email** or **Download** instead.

If something goes wrong

- **You refreshed or closed the page by accident.** Open the game again in the same browser: the start page offers **Resume your game?** Click **Resume**. A refresh in the middle of a turn takes you back to the start of that turn. Uploaded images have to be selected again. The saved game stays on this computer for 12 hours.

- **"That password didn't work."** Check capital letters and spaces, or ask your instructor.
 - **A picture is missing.** The question still works without it. If you have the image files, go back to the start page and use **Optional: upload images**.
 - **The board looks squashed.** Make the browser window wider, or zoom out (Ctrl and – on Windows, ⌘ and – on a Mac).
 - **No internet?** After your first visit, the game works offline, but a game link needs the internet to load your instructor's questions.
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Your privacy

The game runs in your browser. Your answers stay on this computer unless you send or hand in your results. The start page may ask whether you allow visit statistics (Google Analytics): choosing **No thanks** changes nothing in the game. To learn more, read the privacy notice.

Instructors: see the Instructor Guide.